

Amazon Connect Flows Intermediate

Course Summary

Contact attributes

Amazon Connect stores data associated with each customer interaction as contact attributes.

Contact attributes are key-value pairs containing information about the contact, agent, queue, or external data sources.

Common attribute types include: system attributes, agent attributes, Amazon Lex attributes, and user-defined attributes. External attributes store data from external systems accessed through Lambda functions.

Designers can set contact attributes within flows using the Set contact attributes block. The Check contact attributes block allows branching the flow logic based on attribute values. You can access attribute values using JSONPath syntax like \$.Agent.FirstName.

Sensitive data like credit card numbers should be encrypted using the Store customer input block encryption feature based on public key cryptography.

Accessing external data in flows

There are three ways to access external data in flows:

- The **Get customer input block** integrates with Amazon Lex to enable chatbot interactions within flows. It provides access to data like intent names, confidence scores, sentiment analysis, and slot values collected during the conversation.
- The **Customer Profiles block** retrieves customer data from Amazon Connect Customer Profiles using identifiers like phone numbers or emails.
- The **Invoke AWS Lambda function** block runs AWS Lambda functions to integrate with external systems, databases, and APIs, storing returned data in external attributes.

Flows error handling

Design resilient flows to gracefully handle errors and failures. Common errors include invalid user input, unset dynamic attribute values, and failed Lambda function invocations.

When errors occur, one option is to continue past the error with an alternate experience path.

In some use cases, you can gracefully inform the customer about the error and continue. In other cases, depending on your workload, you can disconnect the contact after providing an explanatory message.

Implement error branches to catch and handle different error conditions appropriately.

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Flow design best practices

Take into consideration the following best practices when designing flows:

- Adopt a modular design approach by breaking flows into reusable components for better manageability.
- Follow a standard naming convention and avoid spaces or special characters in attribute names. Maintain appropriate permissions for all integration points referenced.
- Store only necessary data in attributes to maintain security.
- Utilize monitoring capabilities and enable logging judiciously to avoid capturing sensitive information.
- Incorporate checks for hours of operation and staffing availability before routing contacts to agents.
- Use contact data to transfer contacts to agents with relevant skillsets.

